

INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

LT03

Unit 3 Elements of crime and mystery

Mark scheme

June 2024

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2 4 6 X L T 0 3 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 7–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 18 years old so we are judging their skills at the end of Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	- Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. - Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	- Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. - Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Macbeth*

‘When you durst do it, then you were a man.’

To what extent do you agree that Macbeth is presented as a weaker man after his murder of Duncan?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Macbeth* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Lady Macbeth’s statements that Duncan’s murder will make Macbeth ‘a man’
- the potency of Macbeth’s fear immediately after the murder of Duncan
- Macbeth’s nightmares and hearing of voices after Duncan’s murder
- Macbeth’s admittance of his ‘fits’
- the escalation of Macbeth’s violent ambition
- Macbeth’s desire to fight on rather than taking his own life or yielding
- different ideas about ‘weakness’: eg physical, political, emotional.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the introduction of Macbeth as ‘brave’ and as a fearsome warrior
- Lady Macbeth’s language choices in Act 1 Scene 7
- the imagery of Macbeth’s mind being ‘full of scorpions’
- the contrast between Macbeth’s description of himself as being ‘whole as marble’ to later being full of ‘saucy doubts and fears’
- the stagecraft involved with the entrance of Banquo’s ghost
- Macbeth’s last words which are heroic and war-like.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	2
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Samuel Taylor Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*

To what extent do you agree that the central function of the settings in *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* is to reveal the Mariner's journey from crime to redemption?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the setting of the wedding
- the land of mist and snow as the liminal space and time when the Mariner shoots the albatross
- the lack of wind and the intense heat after the shooting
- the idea of home: 'mine own countree'
- the wood where the Hermit lives and ideas about the natural world
- the kirk and ideas about religion
- the literal journey taken by the Mariner.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of place and time as poetic/narrative devices
- the frame narrative's use of the wedding as a setting
- the personification and aural imagery used to describe the ice
- the familiar and solid language used to describe the harbour
- the religious imagery and language associated with the 'kirk'
- the pastoral imagery associated with the Hermit's wood.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	3
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Robert Browning: *Selected Poems*

‘There are few entirely innocent victims in Browning’s poetry.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

In your answer, make detailed reference to ‘The Confessional’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Browning’s *Selected Poems* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the speaker and Beltram in ‘The Confessional’ who are guilty of an illicit love affair
- Porphyria’s visit to the narrator which is (presumably) forbidden
- the suggestions of the Duchess’s unfaithfulness
- the intended victims in ‘The Laboratory’ who ‘laugh’ at the speaker
- the ambiguity around the acts of the patriot: his ‘year’s misdeeds’
- the children in ‘The Pied Piper’ who are presumably entirely innocent and the parents who are not.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the religious narrative of sin in ‘The Confessional’
- the presentation of Porphyria as angelic and having a childlike innocence
- the sexual language and the listing of the removal of Porphyria’s clothing
- the imagery of the bough of cherries in relation to the Duchess
- the first person narratives and biased viewpoints of the criminals
- the Romantic imagery used to describe the children in ‘The Pied Piper’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	4
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Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist*

How far do you agree with the view that at the end of *Oliver Twist*, the guilty are presented as being justly punished?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Oliver Twist* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Fagin's trial, conviction and execution
- Sikes's death which occurs during his attempt to flee justice
- Claypole's pardon for testifying against Fagin
- the Bumbles' loss of their position
- the 'deal' that Monks and Brownlow establish
- Dodger's trial and subsequent transportation
- students may interpret 'just' punishment in a number of ways.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Fagin's focalisation of his trial
- the use of legal jargon and language
- the comic tone of Dodger's trial
- the setting of Newgate Prison
- the gothic imagery used to depict the gallows
- the inclusion of 'And Last' to describe the impacts of the punishments on the characters.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	5
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Edgar Allan Poe: *Collected Stories*

To what extent do you agree that the crimes committed in the short stories of Edgar Allan Poe lack any clear motive?

In your answer, make detailed reference to 'The Tell-Tale Heart' and at least one other story.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Poe's *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the narrator in 'The Tell-Tale Heart' who openly states his crime is not motivated by 'gold' or because he has been 'wronged'
- the narrator in 'The Black Cat' whose crimes result from his abuse of alcohol rather than a motive
- the criminal in 'The Murders in the Rue Morgue' who is an animal and therefore incapable of a motive
- the criminal in 'The Black Cat' who describes feeling a desire to 'do wrong for wrong's sake only' at the point of Pluto's murder
- the narrator in 'The Tell-Tale Heart' whose motive is unusual but is stated clearly as being his fear of the old man's eye.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the cheerful tone of the narrator in 'The Tell-Tale Heart' when describing the murder
- the use of a first person narrative to reveal the regret felt by the criminal in 'The Black Cat' after he has committed his crimes
- the repetition of language that links alcoholism to a disease in 'The Black Cat'
- the opening and ending of 'The Purloined Letter', both of which are concerned with motives
- the inclusion of extended dialogue where Dupin explains the actions of the criminal as 'butchery without motive'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 6

Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories*

‘The crimes committed in Stevenson’s short stories are the consequence of individual flaws rather than the flaws of society as a whole.’

How far do you agree with this view?

Make detailed reference to at least two short stories in your answer.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Stevenson’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Jekyll’s desires which are selfish but which are possibly the consequence of ‘the hard law of life’ which disallows men from pursuing pleasure
- the context of arrogant scientific exploration transcending normal human boundaries as seen in ‘The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde’ and ‘The Body Snatcher’
- the need for the ‘raw material of the anatomist’ in ‘The Body Snatcher’ and the ‘quid pro quo’ dealings which provide it
- Macfarlane’s presumably vengeful and personal murder of Gray
- the pitiless society that results in the death of the ‘poor jade’ in ‘A Lodging for the Night’
- Montigny’s petty murder of Thevenin, presumably because he had been beating him at cards all night
- Markheim’s pleas to the visitant that ‘the giants of circumstance’ have ‘dragged me by the wrist since I was born’ and that he is a ‘bond-slave to poverty’.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Jekyll’s narrative in ‘Henry Jekyll’s Full Statement of the Case’ which opens with introspective focus on his own flaws
- Hyde himself as a symbol of man’s arrogance and overreaching
- the focalised narration which describes Fettes’ early character as being so covetous of success that he will ‘avert the eye from any evidence of crime’
- the public settings of the university in ‘The Body Snatcher’ and the laboratory theatre in ‘The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde’ implying the crimes were committed in pursuit of medical advancement
- the setting of St Benoit in ‘A Lodging for the Night’ whose doors are closed to the needy
- the dialogue on the nature of humanity between Markheim and the visitant
- the ending of ‘Markheim’ where he takes individual responsibility for his murder and takes personal action to cease committing crimes: ‘If my life be an ill thing, I can lay it down.’

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 7

Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*

Discuss the view that Christie presents the crimes committed by the female characters in *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* as motivated only by the need to survive in a male dominated society.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Mrs Ferrars' killing of her husband because he was a 'brute'
- Mrs Ackroyd's theft which is prompted by a desire for financial independence
- Flora's theft which is motivated by her need to 'scheme and scrape and lie'
- Miss Russell whose 'crime' is to cover up an illegitimate child out of fear of losing 'respectability'
- Ursula's 'crime' which is to conceal her marriage because she has been accused of 'entrapping' the son of a wealthy man
- Caroline and Miss Gannett et al whose crime of 'gossip' is a moral one and not motivated by survival.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the significance of Sheppard's male perspective as the narrative voice
- the murder that is the catalyst to the narrative is prompted by a desperate woman
- the repetition of 'leetle/little peculiar about money' to describe Ackroyd's treatment of his family
- the euphemisms in Mrs Ackroyd's dialogue used to mask her crimes
- the emotive language used by Ackroyd when he recounts Mrs Ferrars' crime
- in 'The Goldfish Pond', the contrast between Flora's mourning clothes and her dancing.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	8
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Qiu Xiaolong: *Death of a Red Heroine*

‘Wu Xiaoming is presented as a particularly despicable criminal because he commits appalling crimes despite having lived a life of unearned comfort and opportunity.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Red Heroine* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the personal and exploitative nature of Wu’s crimes
- Wu’s motive for murder: to protect his privilege
- Wu’s enviable position at the Red Star in Shanghai
- the talk about him being promoted to ‘acting cultural minister of Shanghai’
- Yu and Chen’s first meeting with Wu in the luxury of his home
- Wu’s position as HCC.

AO2: Analyse in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the repeated use of the epithet ‘Wu Bing’s son’
- the description of Wu as both ‘red and expert’
- the imagery used to compare Wu to a poisonous snake
- the use of Wu’s mansion for the setting of his first meeting with Yu and Chen
- the obscene and demeaning descriptions on the reverse of Wu’s pictures
- Ning Jing’s ashamed and distressed confession to Yu.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	9
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Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?*

At the end of *When Will There Be Good News*, Jackson Brodie says, ‘Everywhere you looked there was unfinished business and unanswered questions.’

To what extent do you agree that at the end of *When Will There Be Good News*, few questions are answered?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *When Will There Be Good News?* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Andrew Decker’s suicide
- Decker and Needler’s motives or lack of motives
- the lack of resolution in Jackson’s personal life: Louise, Nathan’s DNA test, Tessa
- the detail that Billy had provided Joanna with the gun and the implications of this
- the link between Jackson and Joanna which is explained
- the certainty of a happy and resolved ending for Reggie and Joanna
- the death of David Needler which means safety for Alison and her children.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Jackson’s focalised narrative which includes his musings on all the uncertainties
- the circular structure which returns to the historical crime from the beginning in the final chapter
- the gap in the narrative regarding Joanna’s visit to Decker in prison
- the final chapter which reveals the name of the dog which Joanna couldn’t remember ‘for the longest time’
- the uncertain language used to describe Billy, Jackson and Louise’s futures
- the final sentence which allows for an unambiguously happy ending for Reggie and Joanna.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.